FALL 2007

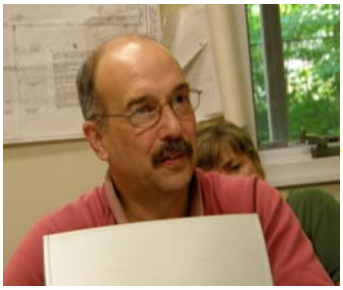
The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume XII Issue I

From the President by Jim Thompson

It was great to see so many of you at the Annual Meeting, Dinner, and Pool Party! The Annual Meeting was sweltering in the barn. Thanks to those of you who endured the heat! Maybe the heat contributed to the shortest Annual Meeting (two and a half hours) that I can remember. If we hold the Annual Meeting in the barn next year, we are thinking of moving the meeting to mid-October when it will be cooler and leaves at their peak color. At the dinner we had a lovely remembrance of Eva Lehman who passed away in August. The Pool Party closed out a very successful summer of pool operations.



Jim Thompson at CMA board meeting.

Thanks to Dilys Parry and her Nominating Committee and to all the candidates who took the initiative to run for the Board. Congratulations to the Board members that were elected at the Annual Meeting. After two years of Board members holding the same positions, we will have significant changes when the new Board takes office in December due to the departure of Cindy Van Meter and Hallie Kerr. I would like to thank them both profoundly for their dedicated service over the last four years. Gordon Cloney and Lois Copeland were elected to their second terms on the Board. Arnold Weinberg and Ron Wohl were elected to the Board for the first time. Carroll Yingling, Jean Cohen and I will start the second year of our two-year terms. We will be working over the next few months to assure a clean turnover at the December Board meeting and that Board members are in position best suited for their interests and talents.

(continued on page 5)

The CMA and Septic Systems by Elmer Broxson

If your water bill includes a sewer charge your house is on the CMA central sewer system. Our permit to operate the system requires that we set up and monitor a schedule for pumping of each septic tank. (The accompanying illustration shows how a septic tank looks and works). It has been nearly three years since our site manager, John Hobday, inspected the tanks. In order to update our records I will contact all homeowners on the system by phone or letter this fall to get permission to inspect your tank. The charge for the inspections will be covered by CMA as in the past. If the inspection indicates that your tank needs pumping we will notify you and recommend a septic service. This

(continued on page 2)

Calendar of Events

Calendar of Events

November 10

10 a.m. Board Meeting

CMA Office

6:30 p.m. Potluck Dinner

Carroll &

Phyllis Yingling J 2

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

December 8

10 a.m. Board Meeting

CMA Office

6:30 p.m. Potluck Dinner

Gordie &

May Kay Cloney K 6

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~



Latest Plans for "The Villages at Coolfont"

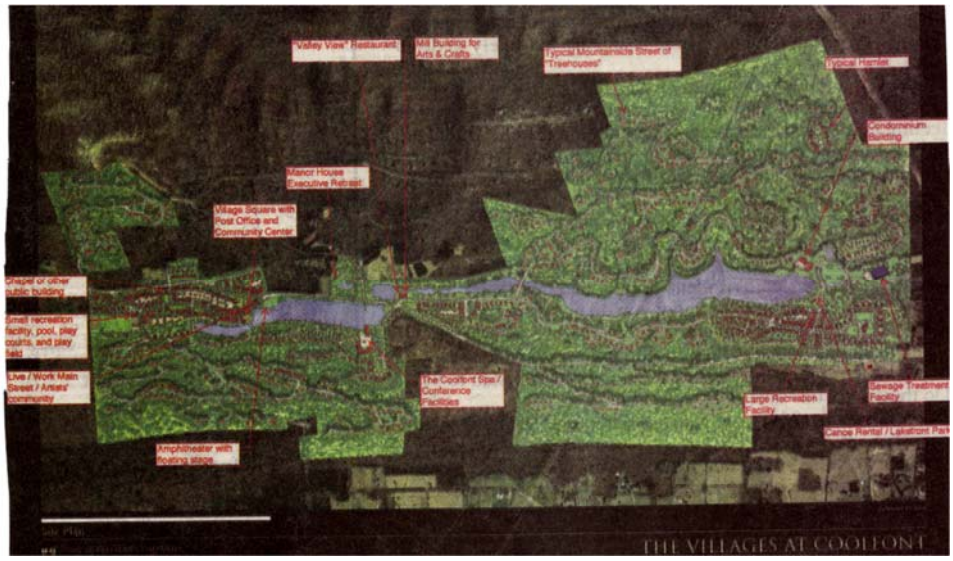
By Lois Copeland

Carl M. Freeman Companies, Inc. hosted a town meeting Monday, October 22. Local officials were among the 100 people who attended the Coolfont project update.

Bob Marggraf, the company's vice president and general manager for West Virginia and Tom Halverstadt, senior vice president and general manager for community development and home building led the discussion. Halverstadt emphasized Freeman's reputation for building environmentally sensitive communities.

They said less than 25% of trees on the former Coolfont property will be removed, the tree canopy will be preserved 150 feet back on both sides of Cold Run Valley Road and only 40% of the property will be developed.

Company officials tried to sooth many of the town's concerns. They are not trying to compete with businesses in Berkeley Springs, no golf course is planned, Coolfont will not be gated and the public will have open access. Freeman is not seeking favor with the Morgan County Planning Commission and local government.



Using color relief drawings titled "The Villages at Coolfont", Marggraf gave an overview of the project.

Cluster housing or "hamlets" containing single family homes, duplexes and triplexes and will be built. 1,200 homes will be built, ranging in price from $250.000 to $800,000.

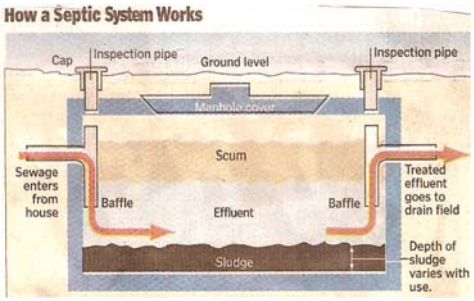
The existing Lake Siri will be expanded

(continued on page 4)

The CMA and Septic Systems (Cont.)

cost will be $212, which includes the 6% WV tax. (If, however, we cannot locate your tank there will be an additional cost depending on the time and materials required to do so). We plan to complete this system-wide inspection by spring.

If your house is not on the central system the maintenance of your septic system is your sole responsibility. By phoning either John (304-258-8141) or myself ing either John (304-258-8141) or myself (202-333-8872) we can arrange for the location, inspection and pumping of your tank.



Winter Driving on the Mountainside

By Elmer Broxson

What attracts us to the mountainside can also be hazardous in the winter. During a storm or under icy conditions it is generally a good idea to avoid traveling. But if you must drive, here are some suggestions to help you avoid getting stuck.

Keep your battery fully charged, tires properly inflated, and make sure you have flares, jumper cables, a flashlight, first-aid kit, spare tire, blanket, extra wiper fluid, a bag of sand and a snow shovel in your car.

Winter driving on a mountain road is a simple exercise in physics. Gravity wants your car to go downhill in the most direct manner, regardless of ditches or trees in its path. Also do not assume that greater speed on curves or hills will successfully "pull" you through an icy section. It will probably offer just enough momentum to send your car skidding. Don't lock your brakes, though, gently reduce your forward momentum a little at a time. For loss of traction, keep a 50 pound sack of play sand and small shovel to spread it as needed. Keep your gas tank full to provide addition weight for traction.

Out and About in Berkeley Springs

By Lois Copeland

Our long, hot, rainless summer is behind us. I don't remember a time when we've had so many beautiful weekends—blue sky, slight breeze and few bugs. So many hours spent on the deck reading, day-dreaming and watching the trees grow.

We didn't spend all of our time on the deck, on September 29 Jay and I attended the performance of the **West Virginia Symphony Orchestra** at Berkeley Springs High School. The evening's performance under the Artistic Director and Conductor Grant Cooper was magnificent. The orchestral arrangements picked for the evening seemed perfect. Cooper conducted Richard Wagner's Overture to Act III of Lohengrin, followed by Antonin Dvorak's Cello Concerto in B Minor, Opus 104 performed by guest cellist, Jolyon Pegis of the Dallas Symphony Orchestra. Pegis received a standing ovation.

For the second half of the concert the orchestra performed Gergei Rachmaninoff's Symphony No. 2 in E Minor, Opus 27. This piece featured "soft harmonic melodies building up to thunderous crescendos", states David Abner of the Morgan Messenger. I absolutely loved the last arrangement.

The sold out performance of 300 were ecstatic, giving the orchestra a standing ovation amid cheers and applause. We hope they return soon.

Since the Spring Newsletter some business have closed, while others have opened. Coolfont's closing has affected Berkeley Springs economically and in terms of its amenities.

An example of this is the opening of **Usha Art Gallery** and **Usha Glass Art** owned by Richard Gonzales located at 758 South Washington in the former Donna's Coffee Shop. I was sad when Donna's closed, wanting a local business to succeed.



Flo Bender-Merola at the Accordian-folded Books class

Classes are organized separately for adults and youth and range from fabric arts to acting for adults and from theater to visual arts for youths. The two classes before Christmas will be devoted to making gifts, decorations and ornaments.

Most classes are at The Ice House. For more information or to register for classes call 304-258-2300.

Usha Art Gallery, upstairs, features the works of twenty local artists such as Ann Darling's quilted tapestries, Pam Didawick's, multi-media works, Lynn Ferris' watercolors and Michael Nathan's metal sculptures. **Usha Glass Art** is the stained glass art studio of Gonzales. There he works on his glass pieces. He will also offer stained glass art classes at his studio.

Usha Art Gallery and Usha Glass Art are open Wednesday through Sunday 11 a.m. to 6 p.m. For more information call 443-624-0754 or 304-258-4649.

Art Saturdays, a project of the Morgan Arts Council (MAC) started September 22 and will continue through June 28. Each class is one to itself so you are not committed to every Saturday. This way you can choose whatever class is of interest to you. Signing up in advance is advised because classes do fill up. (From personal experience, I agree)

Wilkes Street Wine, located in the same building as the Himalayan Trade & Tour offers hand picked, award winning and rated wine from around the globe in a variety of prices, wine accessories, gourmet items and toys and nostalgic candy.

Wilkes Street features a wide assortment of domestic and imported wines inspite of its small space. Cheese and bread will be added after the first of the year.

Wine tasting **Saturday November 10** from 2 p.m. to 5 p.m. will feature organic wine and cheese. They plan on hosting another Wine tasting after Thanksgiving. Owners Monique and Mark Garfinkel live in Silver Spring, Maryland and are planning to retire in Berkeley Springs.

For additional information call 258-0618. **Remember shop locally.**

Snow Plowing

Robert Snidemiller will again plow and sand our roads for the coming winter. When a snowfall accumulates more than 3" he will plow it to a width of 20 feet wherever possible, but raising the snowplow blade 1/2" off the surface to avoid damaging the paved or gravel roads.

If you would like for his crew to plow your driveway each time they plow our roads please call him at 304-258-4278 before December 1, 2007. The charge is the same as last year, $30 per driveway. If you want your driveway plowed only when you are coming up, the charge will be $50—and only if he can schedule it.



Be prepared for winter on the mountainside!

Life Story, Eva Simmel Lehman

By Dick Lehman and Lois Copeland

Our own Eva Lehman, 82, died August 5. She, and her husband Dick were long time fixtures on the Mountainside, one of the first to own a lot. Eva, Dick and their daughter Sandy first visited Coolfont in the summer of 1977, putting up a tent and camping out in the campground above Lake Siri. Later that year they bought lot K-14 and two years the house on K-17, promptly renaming it The Owl's Nest.

She lived a worldly, busy, and interesting life. Eva was born in Jena, Germany. the granddaughter of the philosopher and sociologist Georg Simmel and daughter of two medical doctors.

Because of the spread of violence in the 1930s Eva was sent to England at the age of 13 in 1938, followed by her parents; then immigrating to the United States in 1940.

Eva graduated from Mt. Holyoke College in 1946. She was hired at the newly formed Sloan Kettering Institute for Cancer Research. Her hobbies and interests were many including her life long interest in the peace and consumer action movement and collecting owls!

While on a short-term work assignment in Berkeley, CA in 1963 Eva met and married Dick. Sadly their daughter Stephanie, born in 1965, died at the age of seven. Eva, wanting a child, adopted their daughter, Sandy in 1975.



Over the years their mountainside home filled with owls and friends and family, including Sandy's wedding in 1984. Eva was active in the CMA community for many years, loved the potluck dinners and cherished the Coolfont's New Year's eve parties. She attended even when it became so difficult for her to make the trip to Coolfont in recent years.

We'll miss Eva. With Eva's passing goes a history of Coolfont most of us know so little about.

Latest Plan for the "Villages at Coolfont" (cont.)

The existing Lake Siri will be expanded and run under Cold Run Valley Road, creating a second, 50 acre lake, named Lake Prospect. Lake Prospect will be 36 feet deep at its deepest point. The south end of the property will include condominiums and townhouses built around a town center. Homes and condominiums on the north end will be built in clusters around the new lake and up the ridge on Cacapon Mountain.

Plans include an amphitheater, a community center and a mail delivery area containing boxes for each residence. A conference center, spa, recreation facility and open field are also in the current plans. The spa will be open to the public, but it has not yet been decided whether other community amenities will be. No power boats will be allowed on the lakes.

The water plant will be on the south end where three wells tested successfully. A sewer plant will be built on the north end. When building is completed the water and sewer plants will be turned over to the county's Warm Springs Public Service District. Marggraf said the water and sewer plants would be running before Phase 1 construction is started. Water continues to be a concern among citizens. Both Marggraf and Halverstadt said that water studies are either inconclusive or that water flow will not be adversely affected by construction.



As to traffic concerns, the plans show a loop road with several entrances to run around the community, minimizing traffic on Cold Run Valley Road.

Freeman officials addressed other concerns such as the economy and the need for expanded public services such as fire and police. Since Coolfont will be built over 10 to 12 years, the impact should be minimized. They feel as the community grows, tax revenue will increase and that should offset the costs of services. Halverstadt said that Freeman has a history of hiring local subcontractors and laborers and will do the same with this project.

Freeman Company wants the residents to understand that they want Coolfont to be a part of the Berkeley Springs community. How will Freeman fit into our smaller community, the Coolfont Mountainside community?

Coolfont Hunting Club

By Elmer Broxson

Mr. Robert Marggraf, the Freeman vice-president in charge of developing the Coolfront Resort, has asked us to remind CMA members that its hunting club, located in the undeveloped woods of Coolfont north of the CMA (begun by Sam Ashelman several years ago), resumed its activities on October 1 and will continue them through the spring of 2008. The club members mainly hunt squirrels, deer and turkeys. He assures us that its members are all responsible hunters since they are chiefly local and state officials and local businessmen. If you have any questions feel free to call him at 304-258-6901.



Wet Week with Wee "Wuns" By Marlene Weinberg

The latter part of August our son, Gregg, his wife, Paula, and their two toddlers, Rachel (3 1/2) and Paige (1 1/2) made plans to spend five days with us in Coolfont. Our home is very well equipped for little ones and, with an anticipated outing each day to the CMA pool or the Cacapon State Park beach, we envisioned a great time being had by all. Mother Nature had other plans. The week started out at 61 degrees and raining. The week's forecast called for gradually warming temperatures along with daily showers. Thus, we knew we'd have to get creative in finding alternative activities. With much research we put together a slate of activities that kept the kids thoroughly entertained. We offer our week's agenda for those who may be looking for ways to entertain children or grandchildren under similar circumstances.

Day 1: Shenandoah Valley Discovery Museum; Winchester 540-722-2020;.www.discoverymuseum.net; Wonderful interactive exhibits and games based on science, math and art. Rachel loved the climbing rock wall and Paige's favorite activity was playing with the rubber mulch under the rock wall! Eating burgers and fries on the Pedestrian Mall from the ever-popular Snow White Grill was great fun until rain sent us running for cover.

Day 2: Fun Expedition; Winchester; 540-722-4FUN; www.funexpedition.com. This entertainment center recently opened in a former Circuit City building. Rates vary. Activities include Mini Bowling, Mini Golf, Laser Tag, Climbing Wall, Climbing Structure and Arcade Games. Rachel's favorite was the Climbing Structure while Paige would have spent all afternoon on the three-seat Carousel. Food is available on-site.



Paige on the climbing wall

Day 3: Nature & Recreation Program at Cacapon State Park: 304-258-1022. Offerings change daily. We attended an hour of Crafts, working on popsicle stick boxes, window art and animal magnets, in one of the pavilions next to the Nature Center. The near-by playground was a big hit as it featured equipment no longer found at newer high-tech playgrounds, e.g. see-saws and a merry-go-round requiring someone to propel it by running and pushing.

Day 4: Berkeley Springs Fire House: The firefighters were well-prepared for little visitors. Kid-size fire hats and coloring books were distributed and the kids were invited to climb on the fire engines. A firefighter then conducted a behind-the-scenes tour. Because of a previous commitment, the chief invited us to return at another time for a fire engine ride. Then off we went to the nearby Creekside Creamery to eat lunch on the deck and feed the large turtles and fish that live below.

Day 5: Berkeley Springs State Park: We headed into town to refill our water jugs and let the kids wade in the springs among the minnows—**Very Popular!** The temperature was now in the high 70s and the sun was peeking through; so we headed to the CMA pool for a dip before the visit ended.

Note: We recently learned that the **Berkeley Springs Library** has a Children's Story Hour on Thursday mornings-an activity we will include in future grandchildren visits.



Rachel and Paige atop the fire engine!

From the President (Cont.)

Our major goals for 2008 are to finish planning for our future sewage treatment, develop new Bylaws and comprehensive Regulations and Guidelines that are in concert with our Covenants and Restrictions that go into effect in December 2008, develop a long-range Financial Plan that takes into account coming changes to the Mountainside, continue improvements to the barn and other infrastructure, upgrading our street signage to meet emergency requirements and work closely with Freeman on Coolfont development issues that have the potential to affect CMA.

Don't forget to put our monthly Board meetings and Potluck Dinners on your calendar and plan to join us! These events as well as lots of other CMA information are posted on the CMA Website so ably mastered by Bob Borchers at http://newsite.coolfontmountainside.org—check it out!



Our barn filled for our meeting and dinner.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418

Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Lois Copeland, NL Editor
Phone: 301-530-1115
E-mail: locopeland@aol.com

Jim Thompson, President
E-mail: cma-thompson@cox.net

We're on the Web

www.newsite.coolfontmountainside.org

Martha Ashelman Hosts Halloween Party

By Lois Copeland

Martha Ashelman celebrated her Halloween birthday by hosting her family, friends and the mountainside to a Halloween costume party in the barn. Over a hundred people attended dressed in a wide array of wonderful, original costumes. We enjoyed a delicious buffet and danced to our own Glen Pearson's band.

Martha's three sons and their families traveled from across the country to host the party for their mother. Her family serenaded her with special musical toasts. As you can judge from the pictures a fun time was had by all.



The host and devil Martha!





Martha's grandchildren, Megan left and Ian right.



Can you guess who? Above, Gordie Cloney and Bob Cohen!



Bob and Brigit Borchers dancing to Glen Pearson's Band!



Flo and Larry Merola as, can you guess, Scarlett O'Hara and Rhett Butler!



Is that Jay Copeland consulting about surgery with caveman Dennis Brydges!



We couldn't guess them in person; Phyllis and Carroll Yingling!



Sheila Maher wore those flippers all night, WOW! She really got into the fun-filled evening.